

▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **SALES EXECUTIVE** *see pp. 60–61*
- ▶ **STORE MANAGER** *see pp. 62–63*
- ▶ **CONTRACT MANAGER** Manages the process of selecting suppliers by providing them with detailed information about the goods required and asking them to offer their best price. Contract managers arrange a formal contract between the buyer and seller and keep ongoing relationships with suppliers.
- ▶ **PURCHASING MANAGER** Buys the equipment, goods, and services needed by government departments or large industries.

Depending on the item or season, buyers will often buy merchandise six months before it is sold in stores.



BUYER As a buyer, you can specialize in diverse areas, from fashion to food. To progress, you may need to gain accreditation by a professional body.



MERCHANDISING MANAGER

Controls all of the selling activities in a store or group of stores. This job includes tasks such as analyzing the market, planning product lines and sales promotions, buying, and pricing goods.



COST ESTIMATOR Analyzes data to predict the costs of future business activities, and so determines if selling certain items will make a profit for a retail chain. The factors taken into consideration include the costs of labor, materials, storage, and transportation.



LOGISTICS MANAGER Oversees the transportation of products from suppliers, through distribution centers, and onto the shelves of stores.

SKILLS GUIDE



Good communication skills for explaining buying choices and negotiating prices with suppliers.



A sharp analytical approach for comparing offers from various suppliers and selecting the best.



Good numerical skills to calculate the best deals offered by suppliers and estimate profit margins.



An awareness of commercial needs and trends to ensure customer requirements are met.



Good attention to detail to ensure the right goods are purchased at the right time.